

SCOTT DEMERS'

Dragons Down Eastern Reaches



DRAGONS DOWN: EASTERN REACHES

“The lands to the East had been unexplored even before the dragons devastated this place. But there were thriving communities and vast wastelands beyond what we knew. I could see boundless deserts and gorges cut by deep riverlands. I decided to set foot in these lands to see what adventures await....”

Dragons Down: Eastern Reaches expands **Dragons Down** by introducing new lands to explore, new terrain types, new monsters to fight, new natives with whom to interact, new treasure sites to find, new treasures to loot, new spells to cast, new classes to play, and new lineages to be. New components, other than counters, round tokens, and hero chips, are marked with a small **E** in one corner.

One-Time Rules Adjustments

Hero Class Adjustments

The **Eastern Reaches expansion** introduces the most powerful spells included in **Dragons Down** to date. In order to maintain play balance, the abilities of a few hero classes have been tweaked.

Druid and Illusionist

The Druid's Natural Emanation ability and the Illusionist's Focus ability may only be used to avoid wounding one cube once per combat round.

Magician

The Magician's Knowledge ability may not be used on a magic box containing a wound symbol.

Special Locations Wilderness Tokens

When a hero reveals one of the forgotten city, dwarven ruins, or the new buried temple (see page 2) special location wilderness tokens, draw and reveal one additional wilderness token from each terrain pack in play, as normal. Should another special location be revealed in this draw, mix it back into the pile of wilderness tokens for the matching terrain pack, unless it is the last wilderness token in that terrain pack. i.e. a special location will not be found inside of another special location unless it is the last wilderness token in the terrain pack.

Game Components

Eastern Reaches introduces two new terrain packs called the Dreadful Deserts and the Ruthless Riverlands. Here is what is included in each terrain pack.

Dreadful Deserts

- 6 map tiles including 5 wilderness map tiles and 1 civilization map tile.
- 1 terrain pack setup card
- 1 merchant setup card
- 1 title card
- 9 wilderness tokens
- 2 civilization tokens
- 1 civilization location token

- 10 missions
- 47 monster chips
- 4 native chips

Ruthless Riverlands

- 6 map tiles including 5 wilderness map tiles and 1 civilization map tile.
- 1 terrain pack setup card
- 1 title card
- 9 wilderness tokens
- 2 civilization tokens
- 7 missions
- 51 monster chips
- 4 native chips

Additional Game Components

- 4 class cards
- 4 hero chips
- 6 targeting tokens
- 70 spell cards (35 each of hero starting spell/spell cards)
- 52 treasure and deep treasure cards
- 5 wilderness tokens

Game Setup

Players may choose from any of the terrain packs, including the two new terrain packs included in the **Eastern Reaches expansion**, in any combination.

The dreadful deserts terrain pack is a place of great risk and great reward, having more treasure sites than any other terrain pack. There are special rules for the dreadful deserts explained on page 2 of these rules.

The ruthless riverlands terrain pack is roughly equivalent to the malevolent mountains or cruel caves in terms of reward and danger. The ruthless riverlands provides a method to travel quickly across the map... for the hero willing to part with their gold. There are special rules for the ruthless riverlands explained on page 2 of these rules.

If playing with either of the new terrain packs, roll the additional gray summoning die during the monster activation phase. Results from all summoning dice apply to all map tiles.

Player Setup

Players may choose from any of the lineages and classes. Note that some of the new classes are designed to take advantage of deserts or riverlands.

New Map Tokens

Civilization Tokens

The **Eastern Reaches expansion** includes 4 new civilization tokens. When an empty token is revealed, it behaves exactly the same as empty tokens in **Dragons**

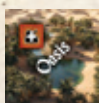
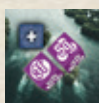


Down. When one of the tokens with a merchant name is revealed, fill the location on the appropriate set up card with the listed numbers of treasures, items, and missions. The merchant behaves exactly the same as a merchant in Dragons Down.

Wilderness Tokens

The **Natives expansion** adds 23 wilderness tokens (1 for each of the 5 existing terrain packs and 9 tokens each for the dreadful deserts and ruthless riverlands, respectively). Mix each of these new tokens into the existing wilderness tokens from the terrain packs in play. Some of these tokens are marked with a + sign on the front face of the token. When moving or exploring a hero may reveal one of the new tokens. Each new token is explained below:

- **Discovery:** Draw one additional wilderness token from the ruthless riverlands pack and place it in the map tile. The revealing hero then rolls the two mission dice and receives the rewards indicated by the dice roll.
- **Buried Temple:** Draw one additional wilderness token from each terrain setup card in play and place them in the map tile. The revealing hero receives 1 LP and 5 fame. Note the rule adjustment for special location wilderness tokens on page 1 of these rules.



Dreadful Deserts

Map Setup (both Open Realm and Exploration mode)

When playing with the dreadful deserts, mix the dreadful desert map tiles in with the rest of the map tiles in play.

Some sides of each dreadful desert map tile contain desert edges with no trees. When placing a dreadful desert map tile, each edge adjacent to another map tile must match the type of edge of the existing map tile (either trees or desert), in addition to matching any paths on existing map tiles as normal.

Note that dreadful desert map tiles contain paths exiting all tile edges. This may help you determine where desert map tiles can be placed during exploration games.

Desert Treasures

Some treasures are specific to the dreadful desert terrain pack and are marked with a desert terrain pack symbol next to the **E** on the treasure card. If the dreadful deserts are not in play, these cards should be removed from play.

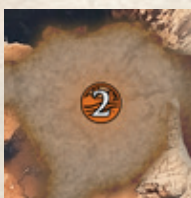


Desert Clearings

Dreadful desert tiles include a new type of clearing - the desert clearing - which has an orange desert icon on the clearing.

It costs one action to move into a desert clearing (similar to a plains or woods clearing). Desert clearings are barren and unforgiving offering little protection from the elements. If a hero ends their action phase in a desert clearing that does not also contain a civilization location, the hero must immediately wound one cube.

Desert clearings have no effect on combat, though some treasures have advantages or penalties in desert clearings.



Ruthless Riverlands

Map Setup (both Open Realm and Exploration mode)

When playing with the ruthless riverlands, the river is always built first. Do **NOT** mix the ruthless riverlands map tiles in with the rest of the map tiles in play. Once you have thoroughly mixed all of the other terrain pack map tiles together, place the port map tile near the center of the table and mix all of the ruthless riverlands map tiles together **except** for the headlands map tile. Randomly draw ruthless riverlands map tiles and connect them, random side up, to the previously placed map tile's river edge (starting with the port). Do this until all ruthless riverlands map tiles have been placed (placing the headlands map tile last).

If playing in open realm mode, proceed with normal map building once the river is built. If playing in exploration mode, place the port in a random clearing on the port map tile (including water clearings). Heroes begin the game in the port map tile using normal exploration rules.

Riverlands Treasures

Some treasures are specific to the ruthless riverlands terrain pack and are marked with a riverlands terrain pack symbol next to the **E** on the treasure card. If the ruthless riverlands are not in play, these cards should be removed from play.

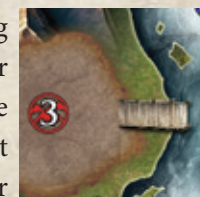


Water Clearings

Ruthless riverlands tiles include a new type of clearing called a water clearing. Water clearings are white and blue and contain a blue river symbol. Water clearings represent both water and nearby small islands. Although movement through a water clearing is via the water, heroes, natives, and monsters are assumed to be on the small islands in each water clearing.



Heroes may only enter water clearings from an adjacent clearing containing a dock (hereafter called a "dock" or "dock clearing") or an adjacent water clearing using a ferry (see ferries below). Once in a water clearing, a hero may only move back to an adjacent land clearing if it contains a dock. Heroes may not move in water clearings without using a ferry unless they have a treasure or spell that allows them to do so. e.g. flying or swimming (see swimming on page 3).

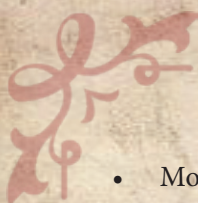


Ferries

Local ferries service passengers on the river between each dock and will transport a hero on the river for a small fee. To use a ferry, a hero must be in a dock or water clearing. A dock is considered adjacent to each water clearing on either side of the dock. Example: All clearings in the image on the right are adjacent to each other. Movement on a ferry follows these rules:



- Ferrying on the river costs a single move action regardless of the distance traveled. A hero may move in either direction any number of clearings on the river, up to and including the dock.
- The ferry will transport a hero no further than the next dock.



- Movement is done one clearing at a time. Should a hero enter a new map tile containing no wilderness or civilization tokens, reveal and place the appropriate tokens in the map tile before deciding whether to proceed further via ferry movement.
- The hero may stop at any water clearing they wish, but may not bypass a dock. To use a ferry to proceed on the river beyond a dock, the hero must first enter the dock clearing and end their move action. They may then continue ferrying further on the river using a subsequent action.
- If the hero enters a dock clearing that has additional movement cost (e.g. mountain or swamp), the hero must spend an additional action to enter the clearing per normal movement rules.
- A ferry will drop off or pick up a hero in a clearing containing a monster. But, a ferry will not move through a clearing containing a monster in a single move action.
- Heroes that use ferry movement to enter a clearing containing monsters will be blocked by the monsters (heroes may attempt to hide). Heroes that performed a sneak action this turn may not ignore any monster symbol results on this hide attempt. However, treasure bonuses and the halfling's lineage advantage would still apply.
- Heroes may leave a clearing containing monsters via ferry movement.
- Natives have no effect on the movement of ferries, unless the native group is an enemy of the hero, in which case they will block the hero as normal.
- Ferries cost 1 gold per clearing entered during the move action. Should a hero wish to use a ferry, but not have enough gold to pay the cost, the hero may pay with treasure or item cards of equal or greater value than the cost of the entire ferry ride in lieu of gold. Ferries will not refund any difference between the value of the card and the cost of the ferry ride. Ferries will not accept red backpack treasures as payment.



Swimming

Some monsters have the ability to swim and some game effects grant the ability to swim to heroes. Swimming is already built into the maneuver speed on swimming monster's counters. Swimming has no specific impact during combat unless mentioned in a spell or other game effect.

When a hero has the ability to swim, the hero may use a move action to move from an adjacent dock or water clearing to an adjacent dock or water clearing. This is not ferrying and costs no gold to do this move.

Each move into a water clearing while swimming costs one action. Movement into a dock clearing incurs the normal cost for the clearing type.

Ferry Movement Example:

A hero in clearing 2 on the Soleford map tile wants to be ferried down the river. Because there is a dock in clearing 2, the hero can use ferry movement and chooses to do so. Note that clearing 2 is the only clearing in the Soleford map tile that can be used for ferry movement as it is the only clearing with a dock.

The hero uses a single movement action to ferry to clearing 4, then clearing 6 on the Silver Current map tile and then to clearing 1 on the same map tile (red arrows). This move of 3 clearings is all done in one action and costs the hero 3 gold, which must be paid immediately.

Note that the hero could not have moved further on the river with this one action because clearing 1 is a dock clearing.

Using a second action, the hero could move to clearing 3 for a cost of 2 more gold (yellow arrows).

Using a third action, the hero could move to clearing 2 on the Ravaging Run map tile for a cost of 2 more gold (purple arrows).



OPTIONAL RULES

Known River

Instead of building the river randomly, players build the river to their liking. Normal river placement rules apply, including placing the port on one end and the headlands on the other. Note that side 1 of each ruthless riverlands map tile is typically easier to traverse than side 2.

Banished Heroes

When playing with the ruthless riverlands terrain pack, players may instead choose to start their hero in any ruthless riverlands map tile. Place the hero counter in a dock clearing of their choice. If starting in a map tile containing no tokens, reveal and place the appropriate wilderness token or civilization tokens before the player takes any actions.

APPENDIX

Class Advantages



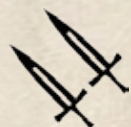
Disciple (Chosen)

The disciple is chosen by the gods to bring peace, knowledge, and harmony to the lands. When the chosen takes possession of any spell books or spell scrolls containing white spells, they immediately learn the spells without rolling any dice or taking any actions. The disciple earns +1 LP and +5 fame for each spell learned this way.



Marauder (Fury)

Marauders fight with a barely contained ferocity that they can choose to unleash in combat. Once per combat round, the marauder may place one heart in either a might box or a speed box as if it was a matching cube. This placement counts against the cube limit for the combat round. During the cleanup phase of combat, a placed heart is moved to the wounded box.



Pit Fighter (Weaponmaster)

Pit Fighters were bred for combat and the glory of the fighting pits. The pit fighter has two targeting tokens - one for the left hand and one for the right hand. Only use one to determine turn order and place the other near the pit fighter's hero board. The pit fighter may equip two one-handed weapons simultaneously. During the targeting phase of combat, the pit fighter may place both target tokens to attack the same target twice or two different targets. Both attacks use the pit fighter's attack speed as normal and are processed normally as two separate attacks.



Vanguard (Primal Strike)

Vanguards are experts at moving fast and striking first. The attack of a vanguard in the first round of combat is done at +1 attack speed.

Monster Manifest

The Siren

The siren sings an alluring song to confuse her enemies. At the beginning of each combat round, each hero must roll the haggle dice and compare it to their wisdom. If the highest die rolled is a closed door or is higher than their wisdom, that hero may not target the siren this combat round.

Hired monsters do not have to perform this check. Hired natives have the same wisdom score as the hero that hired them.

Spells that do not have a target symbol may still affect the siren. Heroes that possess the siren do not get the benefit of the siren's song.

Treasure Manifest

Adventurer's Toolkit

When first revealed, draw one treasure, one item, one mission, and one spell. The base price of the toolkit is the sum of the attached cards. The treasure, item, and mission may immediately be possessed by the hero or left in the toolkit. The spell may be learned as if the toolkit was a spell scroll. If not immediately possessed, the hero must spend an alert action to take the treasure, item, or mission from the toolkit.

Amaranth of Action

One-time use. +1 attack speed for the duration of combat this turn. Does not count against the cube limit each combat round.

Amber Spire

Epic treasure. When first revealed, draw three spells to attach to the spire. The base price of the amber spire is 5 + the price of the 3 attached spells. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. Each spell may be cast one time during combat by placing a might cube and a speed cube on the amber spire. When a spell is this way, process it normally, and then remove the spell from the treasure and the game. The amber spire is not a spell book and spells attached to it may not be learned. No magic cubes are needed to cast these spells.

Ancient Map

Subtract 1 from both dice when performing an action to take treasure from the treasure site in which the ancient map was found. It has no bonus at any other treasure site. Examples: If found in the trove, all loot die rolls at the trove are at -1. If found in the cavernous pit, future dexterity rolls are at -1. A die roll of 1 while using the ancient map equals a grabby hands result when looting.

Aquaria's Enchiridion

Epic treasure. This is a spell book for all game purposes except that it contains 6 spells.

Blade of the Scorpion

Epic treasure. Melee weapon. Two optional might boxes, which may be filled in any order. Any might cube placed in the second might box is placed in the hero's wounded box during the cleanup phase of combat.

Book of Eternal Sand

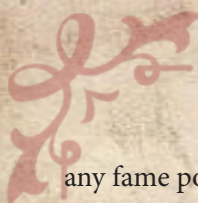
Epic treasure. This is a spell book for all game purposes except that it contains 6 spells.

Canopic Jar

Epic treasure. There are two canopic jars in the game and they have no game effect if possessed individually (heroes still earn the reward for possessing an epic treasure). If a single hero possesses both canopic jars simultaneously, immediately discard both jars, select any revealed civilization location, and note the location in the adventure journal.

From that point forward, should the hero die in any way, they instead place their hero counter in the noted civilization location and do not die. They do not lose





any fame points, spells, or possessions, including cards gained after they found the canopic jars. All cubes remain where they are - healthy or wounded. The hero is undead for the remainder of the game. Should the hero die again, they die normally.

Coin of Passage

One-time use. Only in play if using the ruthless riverlands terrain pack. May use a ferry during a move action without paying any gold.

Dastanas of the Scorpion

Epic treasure. The hero may equip two one-handed weapons simultaneously. They may still only place cubes on one weapon per combat round, but may select either weapon each combat round.

Duffel of Displacement

During an alert action, any treasure or item card may be placed in a random clearing in an adjacent map tile.

Fish Fluke Statuette

Epic treasure. Only in play if using the ruthless riverlands terrain pack. May use ferries at a cost of 0 gold.

Ghutra of the Scorpion

Only in play if using the dreadful deserts terrain pack. The hero does not receive a wound at the end of their action phase when in a desert clearing.

Golden Shroud

Armor. Cancel one sword. The golden shroud may not be struck or destroyed by attacks that hit the hero.

Healer's Flask

Each time a hero heals a cube due to a rest action, heal two cubes.

Khatam of the Quick

Only in play if using the dreadful deserts terrain pack. +1 maneuver speed for combat occurring in a desert clearing.

Kolah of the Horus' Eye

Epic treasure. Once per turn, may look at the top treasure of a treasure site in the same clearing as the hero.

Magewright's Quill

Epic treasure. May use a learn spells action to write a spell that the hero has learned into a spell book or spell scroll. The hero receives one cube that matches the banner color of the spell. If a universal spell, the hero may choose any magic color. The spell is no longer known by the hero and is placed with the spell book or spell scroll. The hero does not earn any reward if they later relearn the spell using normal learn spell actions, but other heroes may do so normally.

Magic Carpet

Epic treasure. The hero may fly. See flying in the core game rulebook.

Mantle of the Djinn

The hero is considered hidden to all undead without performing a hide reaction.

They may not be blocked or targeted by the undead, though they can still be affected by the effects of non-targeted spells cast by the undead. Example: A hero wearing the mantle of the djinn could strike at an undead monster using a melee weapon and not be targeted by undead in the clearing.

Moon Crystal

Only in play if using the dreadful deserts terrain pack. May reroll one search die per search action while in a desert clearing.

Moon Mirror

Epic treasure. May reroll either of the numbered summoning die once per turn. The effects apply to the hero's clearing only with the original die roll applying everywhere else.

Morsel of Might

One-time use. Counts as a might cube in a might box for the duration of combat this turn. This cube does not count against the cube limit and a different card may be selected each round of combat.

Obsidian Dagger

Melee or ranged weapon. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. May be used as a regular melee or ranged weapon by placing a might cube in the upper box or may be used to cast the spell, rule undead, by placing a might cube and speed cube in the lower boxes. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell. May not be used for both abilities in a single combat round.

Pearl of Riversight

Only in play if using the ruthless riverlands terrain pack. May reroll one search die per search action while in a river clearing.

Ripple Strike

Melee or ranged weapon. Only in play if using the ruthless riverlands terrain pack. Ripplestrike has +1 attack speed when combat is occurring in a river clearing.

Riverwalkers

Only in play if using the ruthless riverlands terrain pack. The hero may choose to swim during a move action.

Roc Egg

Epic treasure. No effect other than being valuable.

Sandglass of Eternity

Only in play if using the dreadful deserts terrain pack. Once per turn, receive one additional free action during any turn the hero is in a desert clearing.

Sandstrider Boots

Only in play if using the dreadful deserts terrain pack. When entering a desert clearing, the hero may continue moving to an adjacent desert clearing at no action cost. There is no limit to the number of desert clearings that a hero may enter during a single action.



Satchel of Suppression

During an alert action, may place any one red backpack treasure face-down underneath the satchel of suppression. Only one treasure may be in the satchel at any time. If a red backpack treasure is already underneath the satchel, it is placed face-up in the hero's backpack.

Seafang

Melee weapon. Extra sharp.

Seal of the False King

All hiring is done at 2x price without rolling any haggle dice. Heroes in the same clearing as the seal of the false king have no attributes for any game effects.

Must always be face-up. If face-down and viewed by a hero, it becomes active and is placed face-up (treasure pile, merchant, etc.). If its owner is killed, it is placed face-up in the clearing and anyone entering the clearing immediately takes possession.

Seed of Speed

One-time use. +1 Maneuver speed for the duration of combat this turn. Does not count against the cube limit each combat round.

Serpent Helm

Epic treasure. Armor. A hero may attempt to hire any monster with serpent in their name. There is no cost to pay for this hire, but the hero must haggle 3 times in a row without rolling any door symbols. Any door result cancels the hire attempt and prevents the hero from attempting to hire that monster for the rest of the turn (but not other serpents in the clearing).

Note that the serpent helm does not prevent unhired serpents from blocking and attacking the wearer of the helm. Thus, a hero most likely will be hidden while attempting to hire serpents to avoid being blocked and attacked.

Shekel of Captivation

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Charismatic, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Shekel of Future Sight

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Foresight, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Shekel of Gloom

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Dark Presence, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Shekel of Shaking

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Earthquake, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Shekel of Subjugation

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Orc Call, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Shekel of the Sun

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Safe Haven, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Shekel of the Wind

One-time use. Cubes may not be placed on other weapons or spell cards when using this card. When this attack is resolved, the spell, Gale Blast, is cast. No magic cubes are needed to cast this spell.

Staff of the Sharp Sands

Melee weapon. Only in play if the dreadful deserts terrain pack is in use. +1 sword if the combat is occurring in a desert clearing.

Staff of Thaumaturgy

Epic treasure. Melee weapon. When the possessing hero performs an enchant action, they may choose to enchant the staff of thaumaturgy instead of the map tile. Do not flip over the map tile and place the chosen magic cube on the staff card instead. If the magic cube is used in a box with a wound symbol or the staff of thaumaturgy is unequipped, the magic cube is discarded.

The Sting

One-time use. Attacks by this hero gain +1 sword for the duration of combat.

Storm's Eye

Epic treasure. Only in play if using the ruthless riverlands terrain pack. No movement during a move action may end on a river clearing. Thus, a hero could ferry from dock clearing to dock clearing, or river clearing to dock clearing, but may not swim, or ferry to a river clearing.

Must always be face-up. If face-down and viewed by a hero, it becomes active and is placed face-up (treasure pile, merchant, etc.). If its owner is killed, it is placed face-up in the clearing and anyone entering the clearing immediately takes possession.

Sunblade

Melee weapon. +1 sword when targeting undead.

Tactician's Grasp

Epic treasure. After tactics are revealed, but before attacks are processed (Step 7 of combat), the hero may move one speed cube from attack speed to maneuver speed or vice versa (as long as there is any open speed box). During the clean up phase of combat, any moved cube is placed in the wounded box.

Tail of the Scorpion

Epic treasure. Only in play if using the dreadful deserts terrain pack. If the tail of the scorpion is in a plains clearing, that clearing is treated as if it was a desert clearing for all effects.



Must always be face-up. If face-down and viewed by a hero, it becomes active and is placed face-up (treasure pile, merchant, etc.). If its owner is killed, it is placed face-up in the clearing and anyone entering the clearing immediately takes possession.

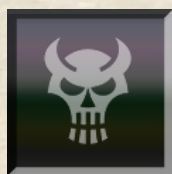
Trinket of Transmutation

One-time use. Remove any treasure or item card from the game that possessed by the hero and receive the gold price of it immediately.

War Weaver's Needle

One-time use. Perform an immediate alert action, even during combat, including being allowed to place an additional speed cube if not already alerted this turn. If used after hero tactics are revealed (step 5), the hero may place the extra speed cube beginning in the next combat round.

Spell Manifest



Black Spells

Black spells are from the realm of death and evil. Black spells tend to bring misfortune, curses, and death to those targeted by it. Black magic is not subtle.

Othersight

Targeted. Instantaneous. Wound one black cube. If the spell hits a guardian, the caster may look at all cards in that guardian's treasure site, even if the site is in another clearing or map tile. Be sure to keep the treasures in the same card order when returning them to the terrain setup card. If the spell hits a hero, the caster may look at all cards and missions of that hero. If the spell hits a native, the caster may look at the cards of that native group. (only relevant if using the Native Possessions optional rule). Otherwise, there is no effect. Does not affect the undead.

Caustic Blast

Targeted. Instantaneous. Wound one black cube. If the target is a hero, they destroy one equipped armor card of their choice. If the target is a monster or native, they are considered unarmored for the duration of combat. Monster and native armor is restored at the end of combat if the monster or native is not killed.

Dark Presence

Combat. Wound one black cube. All heroes, monsters, and natives in the clearing excluding the caster, have one less heart than normal for determining death during attack resolution (minimum one). This spell does not cause natives to become temporary or permanent enemies of the caster. Example: An unwounded merfolk affected by dark presence would be killed by an attack of one damage, as would a giant scarab. The effects of dark presence are not cumulative.

Rot

Combat. Targeted. Wound one black cube. If the spell hits, the target receives one wound of their choice at the end of each combat round until combat ends, including the two additional rounds of combat that occur once all wounds and deaths stop in the clearing. Wounds received solely due to rot do not count for the purposes of combat ending during the cleanup phase. The effects of rot are not cumulative. Does not affect the undead.

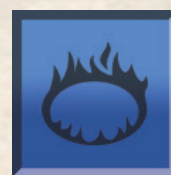
Possess

Permanent. Wound two black cubes. When the spell is resolved, replace the caster with a monster or native in the same clearing. When the spell is inactive, place the monster or native counter on the spell card and use the hero counter again.

This spell works identical to shape shift from the core game, except that it does not need to hit to take effect and the hero may possess a unique monster, including guardians.

If the spell expires (due to break spells or other game effects), the monster or native is immediately placed in the clearing where the caster is located.

Possessing a native turns the targeted native group into a permanent enemy. Does not affect the undead.



Blue Spells

Blue spells are from the realm of conjuring. Blue magic focuses on manifesting and controlling things in the real world. Blue spells tend to break the rules of the physical world for the caster.

Move Gate

Instantaneous. Wound one blue cube. Move a gate in the hero's map tile to any other clearing of the caster's choice in the same map tile.

Town Portal

Targeted. Instantaneous. Wound one blue cube. May only be cast in a civilization location. If the spell hits, the target is placed in a random clearing containing a civilization location.

Water Weird

Targeted (three attacks against up to 3 targets). Instantaneous. Wound one blue cube. This spell takes effect when the spell is cast, instantly targeting all of the selected targets with a speed 0 melee attack and a damage of 2. If combat is occurring in a river clearing or a clearing containing the tarn, abyss, or wreck, all "hit if equals" results are considered hit results on the hit dice.

Doppelganger

Self. Permanent. Wound one blue cube. Any hero, monster, or native that targets the caster has an equal chance of instead targeting the doppelganger. After all hero and monster tactics have been revealed, roll the d6 for each hero, monster, and native targeting the caster. One a roll of 1-3, they target the caster. One a roll of 4-6, they target the doppelganger.

The doppelganger has identical maneuver speed as the caster at all times (e.g. a caster impacted by tentacles would also have their doppelganger impacted by tentacles). If the doppelganger is hit with damage of one or more, the spell immediately expires and remaining attacks on the doppelganger are canceled.

Foresight

Instantaneous. Wound two blue cubes. Set any one of the summoning dice to a side of your choosing. That die will not be rolled next turn and will instead use the selected die face. Should another hero cast a second foresight spell in the same turn, they may change the already selected die or another die.



Gray Spells

Gray spells are from the realm of trickery. Gray spells often involve altering the view of the world around the caster to confuse others, obfuscate reality, or making things disappear completely.

Enfeeble

Targeted. Combat. Wound one gray cube. The target's next hit during this turn causes -1 damage. Enfeeble spells are not cumulative. Does not affect the undead.

Shift Focus

Targeted. Combat. Wound one gray cube. Select a new target at random from all unhidden heroes, monsters, and natives in the clearing. If the target's attack has already occurred this round, the spell has no effect. Does not affect the undead.

Shadowhand

Instantaneous. Wound one gray cube. Select an item or treasure card in your possession and set it aside. Then, randomly draw one card from all treasure and item cards belonging to a merchant in the clearing. Keep the drawn card and replace it with the card set aside. If unhidden during the cleanup phase of combat, the merchant bans the caster from all future interactions and the caster gains an outlaw token.

Orc Call

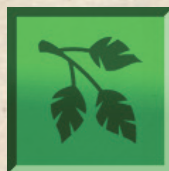
Self. Turn. Wound one gray cube. Orcs will not target the caster during combat and all orcs targeting the caster this combat round have their attacks canceled. The orcs will not block the caster during the action phase while the spell is active. The spell expires if the caster subsequently targets any orc.

During the action phase, the caster may attempt to hire orcs as if they were normal natives, including paying 4x fame in gold. The caster may haggle using their cunning attribute. All rules for hiring natives applies, including the hire being canceled if the caster targets or attacks an orc. All orcs are considered a single native group.

Orc Kin: A half-orc hero attempting to hire an orc using orc call receives a +1 bonus when haggling.

Malediction

Targeted (infinite number of targets). Instantaneous. Wound two gray cubes. This spell affects all monsters, natives, and heroes (including hidden heroes) in the clearing except for the caster. The spell causes a single individual melee attack of 1 damage against each target. Does not affect the undead.



Green Spells

Green spells are from the realm of nature. Green magic seeks to live harmoniously with the natural world. Green magic calls upon the wild to aid the caster.

Scout

Self or other. Turn. Wound one green cube. Once next turn the hero may reject a drawn wilderness token and mix it back into the pool of matching wilderness tokens and draw a new one, which must be put into play.

Good Wind

Self or other. Combat. Wound one green cube. May reroll any number of dice on the next ranged attack die roll.

Wildshape

Self. Permanent. Wound one green cube. When this spell is cast the caster selects any non-undead, non-unique monster counter from the monster tray whose type is printed on the map tile in which the caster resides.

This spell works identical to shape shift from the core game, except as follows:

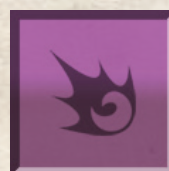
- Whenever the spell is active, the caster must select a monster printed on the map tile in which the caster resides.
- If the hero moves to a new map tile while the spell is active, they return the selected monster chip to the monster tray and must select a new monster printed on the map tile being entered, gaining all characteristics of that monster immediately.

Earthquake

Targeted (infinite targets). Instantaneous. Wound one green cube. Targets all non-flying, unhidden heroes, monsters, and natives in the clearing. The attack is a ranged attack with a base damage of two. If in cave clearing, the base damage is three and the spell also targets all flying heroes, natives, and monsters.

Sunder

Instantaneous. Wound two green cubes. May only be cast while on an edge map tile. Move the caster's tile to any other empty location touching two or more map tiles. The affected map tile may be rotated as the caster wishes, but must be placed in such a way that all paths on the map tile and adjacent map tiles connect to existing paths.



Purple Spells

Purple spells are from the realm of sorcery. Purple magic is about the raw power of magic calling upon sorcery to create energy and control it in the real world. Purple spells create, change, and destroy.

Mana Shield

Self or other. Combat. Wound one purple cube. The next hit of damage one or more against this target deals no damage or wounds, but destroys the mana shield.

Magic Snare

Targeted. Instantaneous. Wound one purple cube. The target suffers -1 maneuver speed and loses the ability to fly for the duration of combat.

Gale Blast

Targeted. Instantaneous. Wound one Purple cube. The caster may move the target to an adjacent clearing along a normal path or river. If in a mountain clearing, may move the target to a clearing up to two normal paths/streams away. The target receives one wound.

Lightning

Targeted. Ranged Attack. Instantaneous. Wound one Purple cube. The target is



attacked by a ranged attack with a base damage of 1 + 2 swords. If in a mountain or water clearing, the spell does and additional +1 sword in damage. All ranged damage bonuses and penalties rolled are doubled (e.g. +1 is +2, -2 is -4, etc.).

Pyroclasm

Targeted (infinite targets). Ranged Attack. Instantaneous. Wound two purple cubes. Each target the spell individually hits is attacked by a separate ranged attack with a base damage of 2 + 2 swords.



White Spells

White spells are from the realm of life and good. White spells tend to heal, promote life, and bring peace. White magic targets the undead as an abomination.

Minor Mend

Self or other. Instantaneous. Repair one damaged armor card.

Panoply

Self or other. Combat. Wound one white cube. The target receives no wound caused by non-spell attacks for next combat round. The target can still be killed outright. The target can still take wounds in the same combat round the spell is cast.

Major Heal

Combat. Wound one white cube. All unhidden heroes, monsters, and natives in the clearing heal two wounds.

Safe Haven

Turn. Wound one white cube. During next turn's monster activation, each numbered summoning die summoned one less monster to the hero's clearing. Other clearings, and guardians, are not affected.

Renewal

Permanent. Wound two white cubes. At the end of each combat round, including the two rounds at the end of combat during which nothing happens, roll the two monster dice. If neither die shows a monster symbol, heal one cube.



Yellow Spells

Yellow spells are from the realm of enchantment. Yellow spells tend to enchant, befuddle, and mesmerize. Yellow magic is subtle, but powerful for the caster who wields it well.

Great Parley

Self or other. Turn. Wound one yellow cube. Reroll any number of dice during one haggle attempt.

Mesmerize

Targeted. Combat. Wound one yellow cube. The monster or native does not change tactics for the duration of combat. Does not affect guardians or the undead.

Counterplay

Targeted. Combat. Wound one yellow cube. The target must roll one additional hit die when their attack speed is not faster than their target's maneuver speed. Does not affect the undead.

Charismagic

Self or other. Turn. Wound one yellow cube. The next trade or hire action by this hero begins at one lower multiplier. Example: The price for a hire action would begin at 3x the native's fame value instead of 4x. Does not affect the undead.

Prismatism

Self. Permanent. Wound two yellow cubes. The caster may place two different colored magic cubes in the map tile when enchanting. The caster must possess both colors of cubes.

CREDITS AND ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Game Design and Development: **Scott DeMers**

Additional Game Design Concepts: **Samuel DeMers**

Producer: **Sean Brown**

Artwork and Graphic Design: **Marco Morte & Scott DeMers**

Rules Editing: **Scott DeMers and the entire Dragons Down Discord community**

Game Icons: **Dragons Down uses icons from Game-Icons.net and the great work done by Lorc, Delapouite & other contributors. Some edits were made to icons.**

(C) Copyright 2026 Active Magic Games and Mr. B Games, all rights reserved. No part of this product may be reproduced without specific written permission. The Dragons Down and Active Magic Games logos are a trademark of Active Magic Games. The Mr. B Games logo is a trademark of Mr. B Games. Actual components may vary from those shown. Made in China.

This is a hobby gaming product and not a toy. It is not intended for use by anyone under 14 years of age.



Ferrying

To use a ferry, a hero must be in a dock or water clearing. A dock is considered adjacent to each water clearing on either side of the dock.

- Ferrying on the river costs a single move action regardless of the distance traveled. A hero may move in either direction any number of clearings on the river, up to and including a dock.
- The ferry will transport a hero no further than the next dock.
- Movement is done one clearing at a time. Should a hero enter a new map tile containing no wilderness or civilization tokens, reveal and place the appropriate tokens in the map tile before deciding whether to proceed further via ferry movement.
- The hero may stop at any water clearing they wish, but may not bypass a dock. To use a ferry to proceed on the river beyond a dock, the hero must first enter the dock clearing and end their move action. They may then continue ferrying further on the river using a subsequent action.
- If the hero enters a dock clearing that has additional movement cost (e.g. mountain or swamp), the hero must spend an additional action to enter the clearing per normal movement rules.
- A ferry will drop off or pick up a hero in a clearing containing a monster. A ferry will not move through a clearing containing a monster.
- Heroes that use ferry movement to enter a clearing containing monsters will be blocked by the monsters (heroes may attempt to hide). Heroes that performed a sneak action this turn may not ignore any monster symbol results on this hide attempt. However, treasure bonuses and the halfling's lineage advantage would still apply. Heroes may leave a clearing containing monsters via ferry movement.
- Natives have no effect on the movement of ferries, unless the native group is an enemy of the hero, in which case they will block the hero as normal.
- Hero may pay for ferries with treasure or item cards of equal or greater value than the cost of the entire ferry ride in lieu of gold. Ferries will not refund any difference between the value of the card and the cost of the ferry ride. Ferries will not accept red backpack treasures as payment.

Swimming

Some monsters have the ability to swim and some game effects grant the ability to swim to heroes. Swimming is already built into the maneuver speed on swimming monster's counters. Swimming has no specific impact during combat unless mentioned in a spell or other game effect.

When a hero has the ability to swim, the hero may use a move action to move from an adjacent dock or water clearing to an adjacent dock or water clearing. This is not ferrying and costs no gold to do this move.

Each move into a water clearing while swimming costs one action. Movement into a dock clearing incurs the normal cost for the clearing type.

Desert Clearings

It costs one action to move into a desert clearing. If a hero ends their action phase in a desert clearing that does not also contain a civilization location, the hero must immediately wound one cube.

Native Summoning

Below are the locations to which native groups may be summoned. The civilization locations below are in alphabetical order and can be used as a reference for several of the missions included in the game.

Civilization Location	Terrain Pack			
Campfire		Bashkirs	Elves	
Encampment		Bashkirs		Sellswords
Inn		Rogues	Watch	Sellswords
Keep		Consul	Knights Watch	Soldiers
Medina		Aurorans Rogues		
Mine		Consul	Dwarves Watch	Soldiers
Outpost		Consul Rogues		Soldiers Wardens
Port			Watch	Mariners Sellswords
Sanctuary		Bashkirs Consul Priests	Elves	
Village		Consul	Watch	Soldiers Villagers

Natives that begin in the native tray • **Natives that begin on the map.**

Natives will not summon to a clearing containing monsters.
Natives that are in a clearing with monsters are placed in the native tray.

